

2000 - 38

CFO-ORC FILE :

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD _____ UNUSUAL RECORD X

Red 1/29/01 wpl

7-0 (A)

Species: Buff-breasted Sandpiper (*Tryngites subruficollis*)**Date:** 12 Sept 2000**Number seen:** two**Sex:** unknown**Plumage:** juvenal**Locality:** Jackson Lake State Park**Elevation:** about 4430'**Nearest town:** Wiggins**County:** Morgan**Time observed:** about 12:20-12:35 MDT**Duration of observation:** about 15 minutes continuous

Description: I was birding the dam end of Jackson Lake. Due to the very low water level there, a peninsula formed jutting from the dam towards the middle of the lake. Along the north side of this peninsula I observed 2 juvenile Buff-breasted Sandpipers foraging together.

In comparison to nearby Baird's Sandpipers (*Calidris bairdii*), both birds were slightly taller with longer legs and stood erect with head held high much of the time on a long, thin neck. Their underparts were a solid creamy-tan color that extended from the head to the belly, becoming much paler (almost entirely white) at the belly and vent areas. This color extended up from the chest onto the neck and extended around the large, black eyes, covering much of the side of their heads, then becoming the basal color for the thinly streaked (dark brown/black streaks) crown and nape. Their upperparts had a strong mottled appearance. The wing coverts were a darker tan than the body with black centers, running along the feather shafts, that extended and expanded towards the tips. The remaining upperpart feathering (scapulars, etc) were all dark centered with bold white edging. There was very indistinct streaking or mottling on the upper chest which was more apparent as a patch on either side of the upper chest just below the base of the neck and immediately in front of the bend of the wings. Their legs were yellowish-orange. Their bills were thin, of short to medium length, and rounded at the slightly drooping tip. Both actively fed (continuously running a foot or so before pecking at the ground) on the moist, but not muddy, shoreline about 30 feet from the water.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): I heard none.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? I have seen dozens of this species in Indiana and Louisiana during fall migrations.

Light conditions: clear sky, sun above and behind me and birds

Optical equipment used: Zeiss 7x42, Kowa 20x60 scope

Distance, and how estimated: estimated closest distance at 35 meters

Other observers who saw the bird with you: none

Other observers who saw the bird independently: many birders saw these birds for several days afterwards

If photographed, type of equipment and film: through scope with 28-80 mm lens on a Canon EOS Elan II hand-held camera using Fujichrome Sensia II 200 speed slide

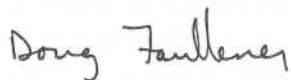
List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: National Geographic Birds of North America, 3rd ed.

I was able to readily observe every plumage detail portrayed on the book plates while viewing the live birds through the scope (60x at the time) at a distance of about 50 meters.

b) after observation: none

Reporting observer: Doug Faulkner

Signature: 

Address: Rocky Mountain Bird Observatory, 14500 Lark Bunting Lane, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: This report was written on 13 September 2000 from memory.